

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N

Introduction to Penn State's AI Studio

Note: These are not slides; they're more like a list of instructions for a 50-minute class session...

Start (slides)

Give them an overview of what generative models and AI agents are. This can be short – like 5 minutes. Emphasize that if what you're saying doesn't make sense, it will soon enough.

Introduce **AI Studio** (slides)

1. Provide the URL and a description
2. Talk about advantages:
 - It's free!
 - OpenChat = three models in one place
 - “Operates in a protected environment”
 - Managed and supported by the University
 - Allows agent creation
3. Dig into privacy / data protection:
 - PSU's information classification levels...
 - Level One / Public = Low Risk (Course Descriptions, Press Releases, Public Website Information)
 - Level Two / Internal = Moderate Risk (Course Grades, Syllabi and Course Content)
 - Level Three / Sensitive = High Risk (SSN, Financial Aid Information, Individually Identifiable Health Information, Driver's License Number)
 - Level Four / Restricted = Critical Risk (Controlled Unclassified Information, Payment Card Information, Federal Contract Information)
4. Talk about logistics:
 - Logging in
 - Usage limits / tokens

Example One: Generative AI

1. Log into AI studio
2. Pick a model (e.g., Claude Sonnet)
3. Click the little “+” to show what one can input / do
4. Prompt (say) ChatGPT:

“I am an advanced undergraduate political science major, beginning a research project on the contemporary government of Eswatini. Please briefly summarize existing empirical, quantitative, peer-reviewed research on state-building, governance, and human rights in that country.”

Then:

1. Review the result
 2. Re-do the prompt using another model (e.g., Gemini)
 3. Compare the two, using a third model (e.g., Claude)
5. Show how you can:
- ...regenerate an answer, play it back (audio), copy to clipboard
 - ... save / export the .txt of the chat + responses; save to a project (coming soon!)